Bruce R. McConkie — The Begetting of Jesus Christ

"Only Begotten Son of God"

"These name-titles all signify that our Lord is the only Son of the Father **in the flesh** [mortality]. Each of the words is to be understood literally. Only means *only;* Begotten means *begotten;* and Son means *son.* Christ was begotten by an Immortal Father in the **same way** that mortal men are begotten by mortal fathers." *Mormon Doctrine,* pg. 546-47.

"Begotten" — A past participle of beget.
"Beget" — To father; sire. *American Heritage Dictionary*

"Son of God"

"God the Father is a perfected, glorified, holy Man, an immortal Personage. And Christ was born into the world as the literal Son of this Holy Being; he was born in the same personal, real, and literal sense that any mortal son is born to a mortal father. There is nothing figurative about his paternity; he was begotten, conceived and born in the normal and natural course of events, for he is the Son of God, and that designation means what it says." *Mormon Doctrine,* pg. 741.

"Knowest Thou the Condescension of God?"

"Without overstepping the bounds of propriety by saying more than is appropriate, let us say this: God the Almighty, the Maker and Preserver and Upholder of all things; the Omnipotent One; he by whom the sidereal heavens came into being, who made the universe and all that therein is; he by whose word we are, who is the Author of that life which has been going on in this system for nigh unto 2,555,000,000 years [*Times and Seasons* 5:758]; God the Almighty, who once dwelt on an earth of his own and has now ascended the throne of eternal power to reign in everlasting glory; who has a glorified and exalted body, a body of flesh and bones as tangible as man's; who reigns in equity and justice over the endless billions of his spirit children who inhabit the worlds without number that roll into being at his word—God the Almighty, who is infinite and eternal, elects, in his fathomless wisdom, to beget a Son, an Only Son, the Only Begotten in the flesh.

"God, who is infinite and immortal, condescends to step down from his throne, to **join** with one who is finite and mortal in bringing forth, 'after the manner of the flesh,' the Mortal Messiah." *Mortal Messiah,* 1:314-315.

"Whose Son Is He?"

"As far as those who understand the scriptures and the plan of salvation are concerned, the issue is not 'Whose Son is he?'—for that is well established: he is the Son of God, born in the manner we have set forth. The issue is, Was the child in Mary's womb the Son who had been sired by the Father? Had Elohim and Mary **joined together** to bring into mortality the One who would abolish death and bring life and immortality to light through the gospel?"

Mortal Messiah, 1:330-331.